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VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

School of Computing Science and Engineering
Kothri Kalan, Sehore, Madhya Pradesh - 466114

PROJECT REPORT

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Program: Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech)

Branch: Computer Science and Engineering (Core)

Year: 1st

Course Code: CSE0001

Submission Date: 31/3/26

Project Title: Digital Literacy

Introduction & Project Overview

Welcometo the Digital Literacy Essentialsproject.In today's increasingly interconnected world, digital literacy extends far beyond basic computer skills; it encompasses the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information responsibly across various digital platforms. This project serves as a comprehensive 'cheat sheet' designed specifically for the modern student. It navigates through fundamental competencies, ranging from safe internet practices highlighting crucial cybersecurity measures and data privacy to the cultivation of a professional online presence. By exploring diverse topics, this report highlights how a well-managed digital footprint can significantly enhance career opportunities. Through a series of structured tasks, we delve into practical applications, exploring everything from coding platforms and collaborative tools to professional communication etiquette and cybercrime awareness, equipping students with essential skills for the digital age.

Core Topics Included:

- **What is Digital Literacy?** A breakdown of the core competencies.
- **Safe Internet Practices:** Essential tips for cybersecurity and data privacy.
- **Professional Online Presence:** How to build a 'digital footprint' that works for your career.

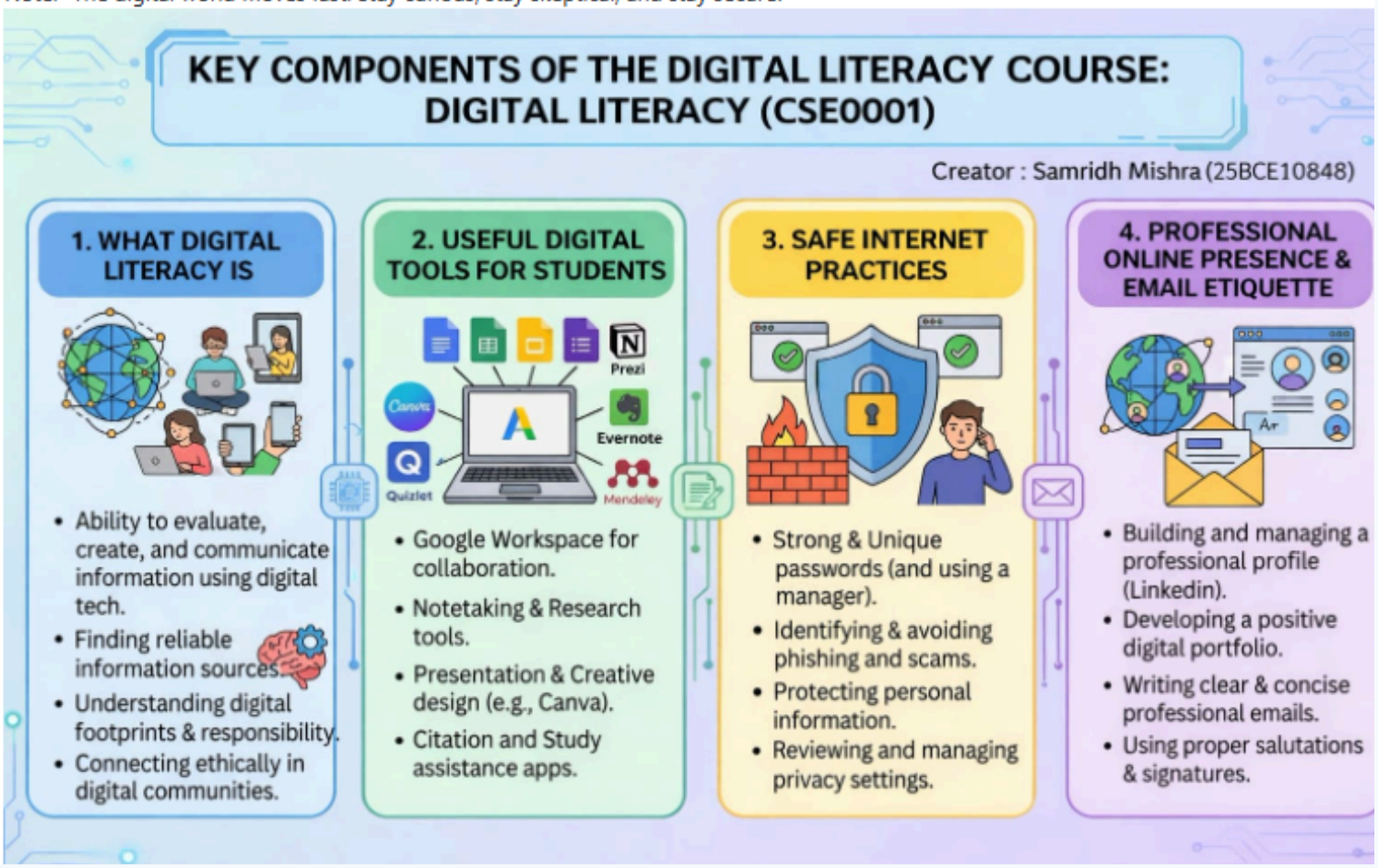
Task 1: Digital Literacy Infographic

Forthe first task, I created a comprehensive digital literacy infographic designed to serve as a quick reference guide for students. Utilizing graphic design principles, I structured the visual resource to highlight three primary takeaways: the importance of critical thinking before clicking on suspicious links to combat misinformation, the necessity of robust privacy measures like strong passwords and Two-Factor Authentication (2FA), and the realization that personal branding on platforms like LinkedIn acts as a digital resume. Reflecting on this task, I realized how crucial visual communication is in breaking down complex cybersecurity concepts into digestible, actionable advice. The creation process reinforced my understanding that the digital world is fast-paced, requiring users to remain curious, skeptical, and secure.

Task-1 : Presentation/digital-literacy-infographic.png

Key Takeaways from the Resource

Think Before You Click: Always verify the source of information to avoid misinformation.Privacy is Power: Use strong, unique passwords and enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA).Your Brand Matters: Treat your LinkedIn and social media profiles as your digital resume.Ambassador Note: "The digital world moves fast. Stay curious, stay skeptical, and stay secure!"



Moving forward, I plan to continuously update this infographic and share it as a resource as new digital threats and best practices emerge.

> Ambassador Note: 'The digital world moves fast. Stay curious, stay skeptical, and stay secure!'

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

A professional digital presence is no longer optional—it is expected. In this task, I set up a foundational portfolio across the key platforms that employers, internship coordinators, and the academic community frequently check: GitHub and LinkedIn. Setting up the GitHub repository was an exercise in technical showcase. Its primary purpose is to display my technical proficiency, version control habits, and collaborative coding abilities. I uploaded documentation for a Gym Management System and an AI-Powered Chessbot, demonstrating practical application of my skills. Simultaneously, I curated my LinkedIn profile to act as a dynamic professional network. The focus was on a targeted headline, a data-driven 'About' section, and securing endorsements for my skills in Python and AI development. The future plan involves actively maintaining both platforms: continuously committing code to GitHub to reflect my learning trajectory, and publishing insightful articles on LinkedIn to engage with industry professionals and the broader tech community.

GitHub: The Project Repository

LinkedIn: The Professional Network

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

As a Digital Ambassador, guiding peers toward the right online tools for studying, practicing, and collaborating is essential. This task focused on two categories: competitive coding platforms and cloud collaboration tools. For the coding practice component, I utilized

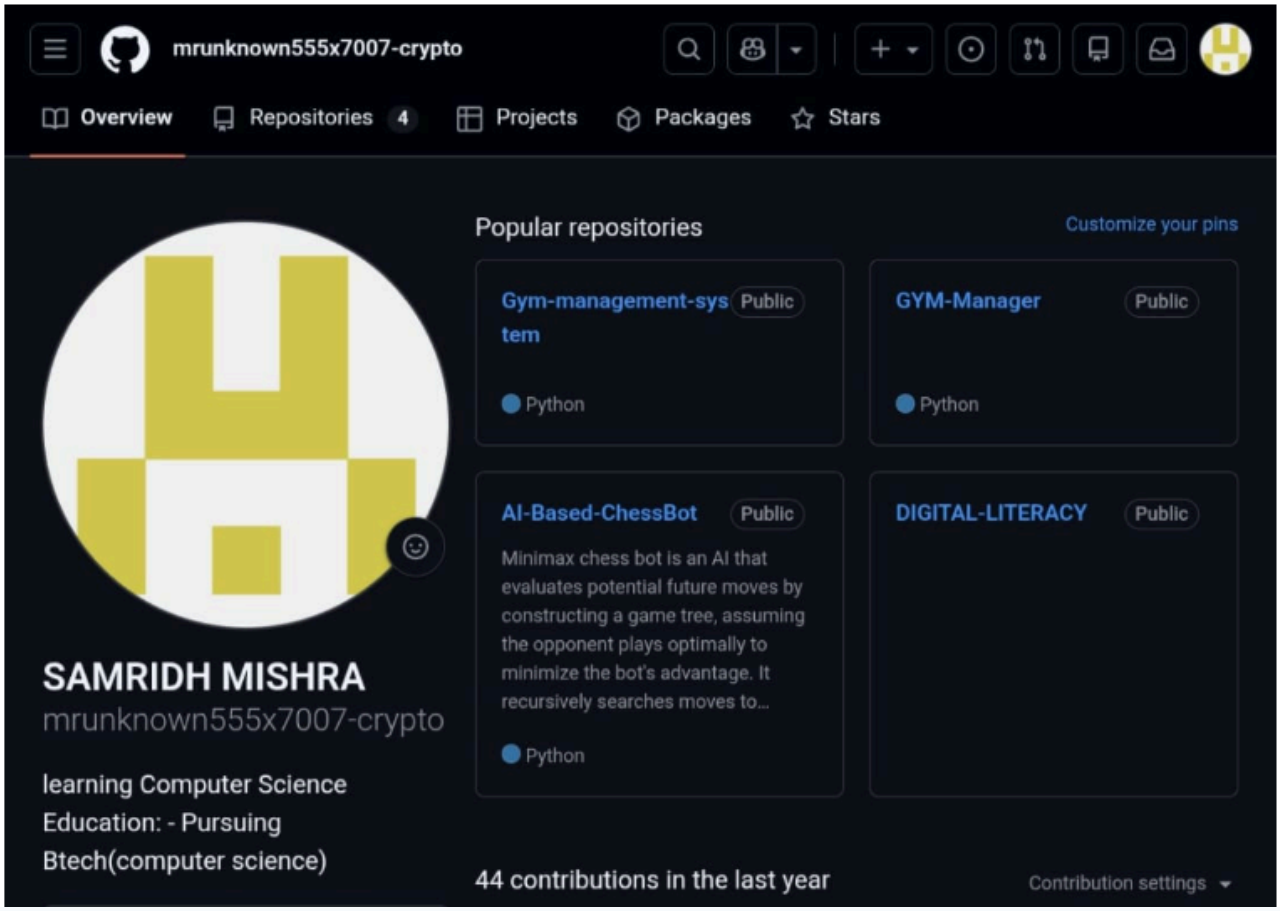
Task-2 : BUILD YOUR STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

A professional digital presence is no longer optional — it is expected. In this task, you will set up your foundational portfolio across the key platforms that employers, internship coordinators, and the academic community check.

1. GitHub: The Project Repository

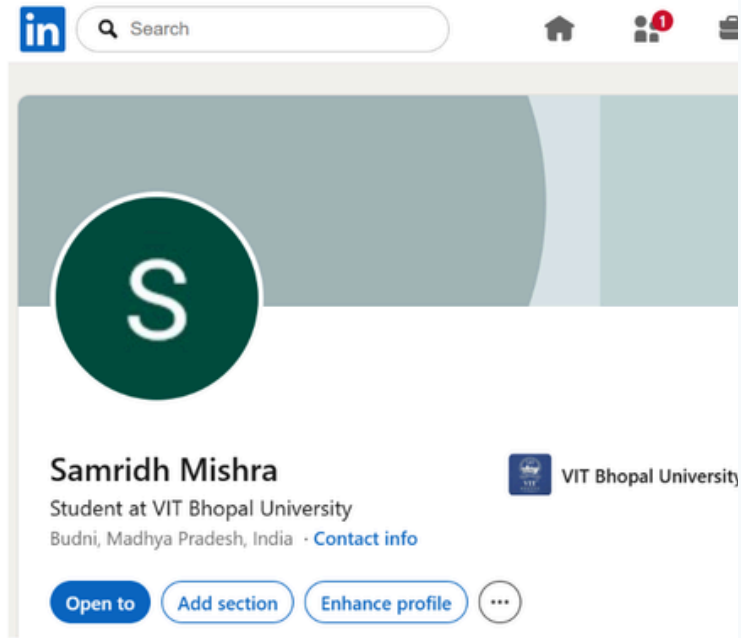
Purpose: Showcases technical proficiency, version control habits, and collaborative coding.

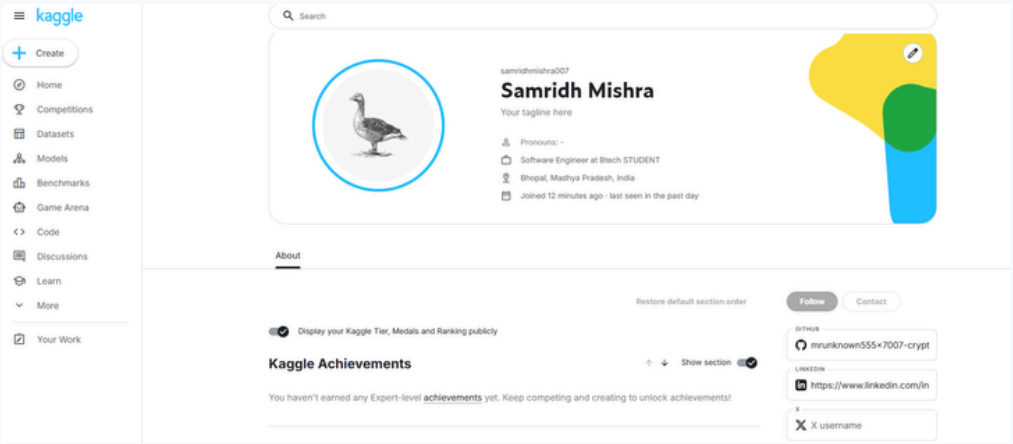
Key Features: Documentation for the Gym Management System and the AI-Powered Chessbot.



2. LinkedIn: The Professional Network

Purpose: Connects me with industry professionals and highlights my career trajectory.Focus: A curated headline, a da
and endorsements for skills in Python and AI development.

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Create
Home
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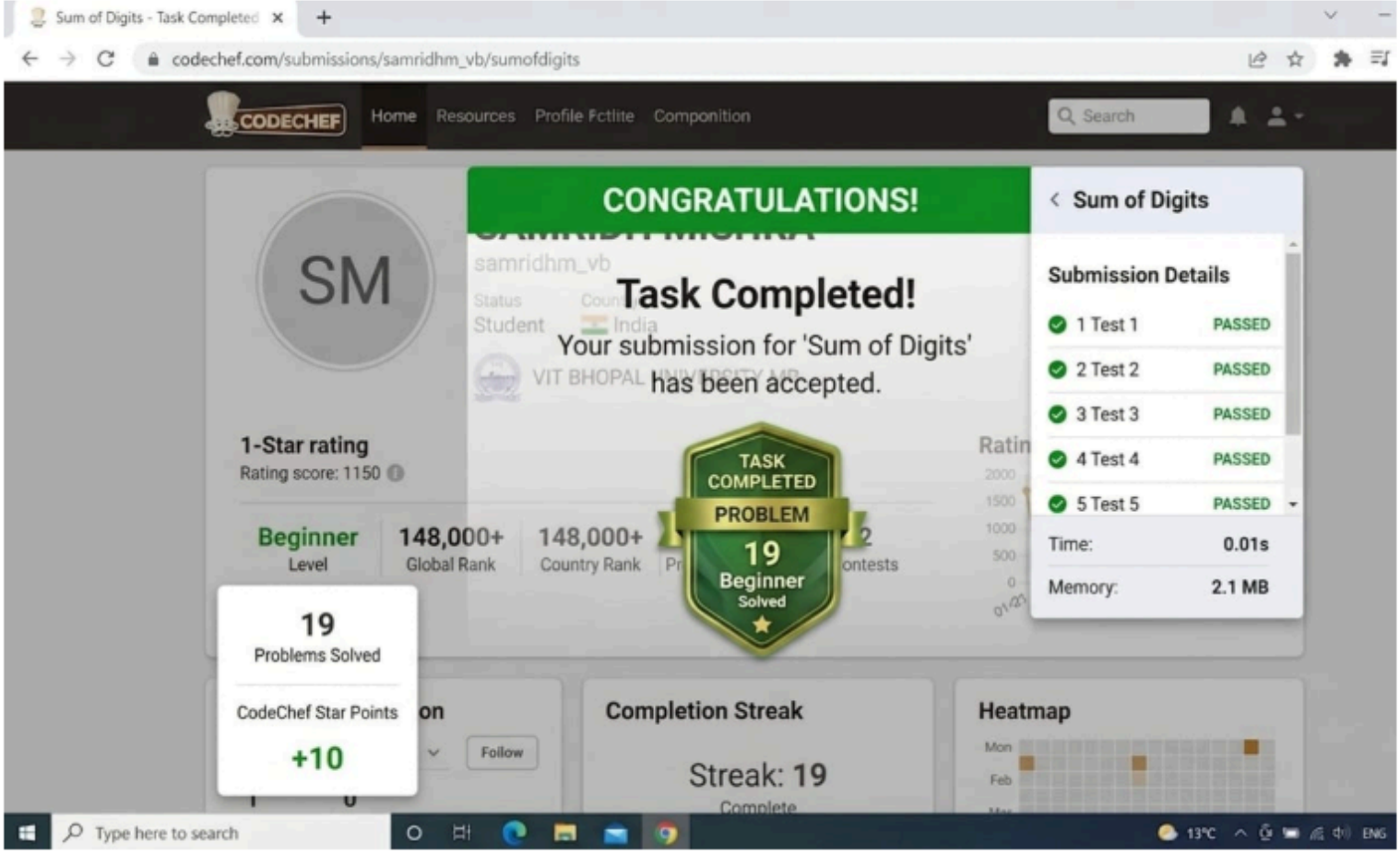
Software Engineer at Btech STUDENT
Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, India
Joined 12 minutes ago · last seen in the past day
About
Restore default section order
Follow
Contact
Display your Kaggle Tier, Medals and Ranking publicly
Kaggle Achievements
Show section
You haven't earned any Expert-level achievements yet. Keep competing and creating to unlock achievements!
GITHUB
mrunknown555×7007-crypt
LINKEDIN
https://www.linkedin.com/in
X
X username

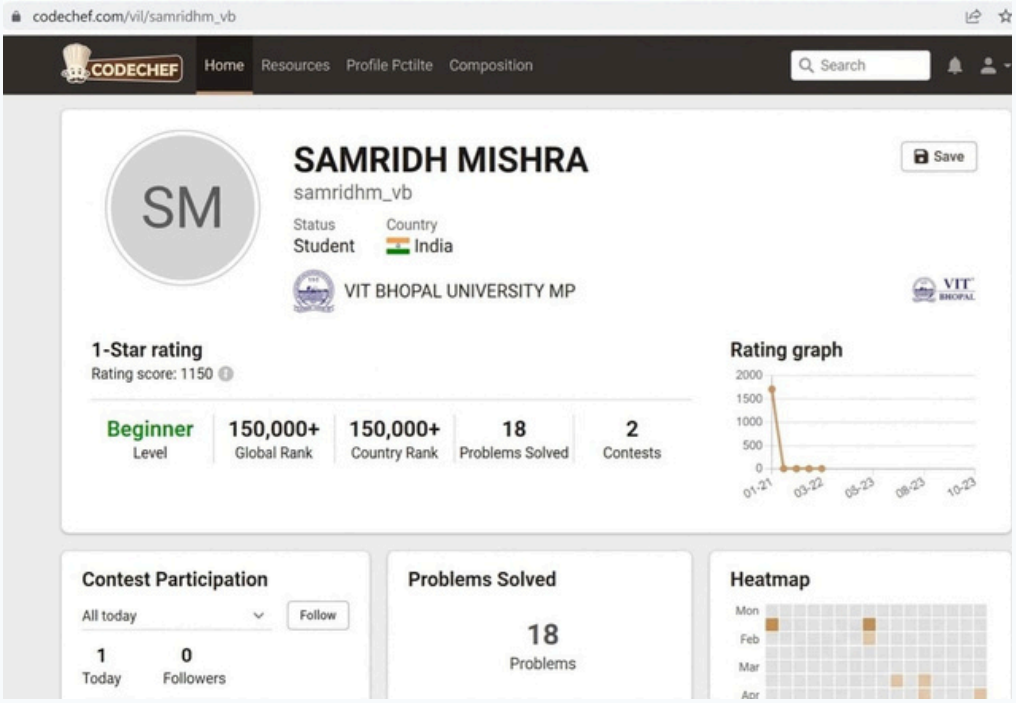
Task-3 : EXPLORE COADING & COLLABRATION PLATFORM

Part A: Coding Practice

In this section, I explored competitive programming and skill-building platforms to enhance my technical proficiency.

- As a Digital Ambassador, you need to be able to guide your peers toward the right online tools for studying, practising, and collaborating. This task builds familiarity with two categories: coding practice platforms and cloud collaboration tools. `Platform: CodeChef` Completed Challenge: Python Introduction / "Solve Me First"Evidence: * Completed challenge screenshots and earned badges are located in the task-3-platforms/ directory.

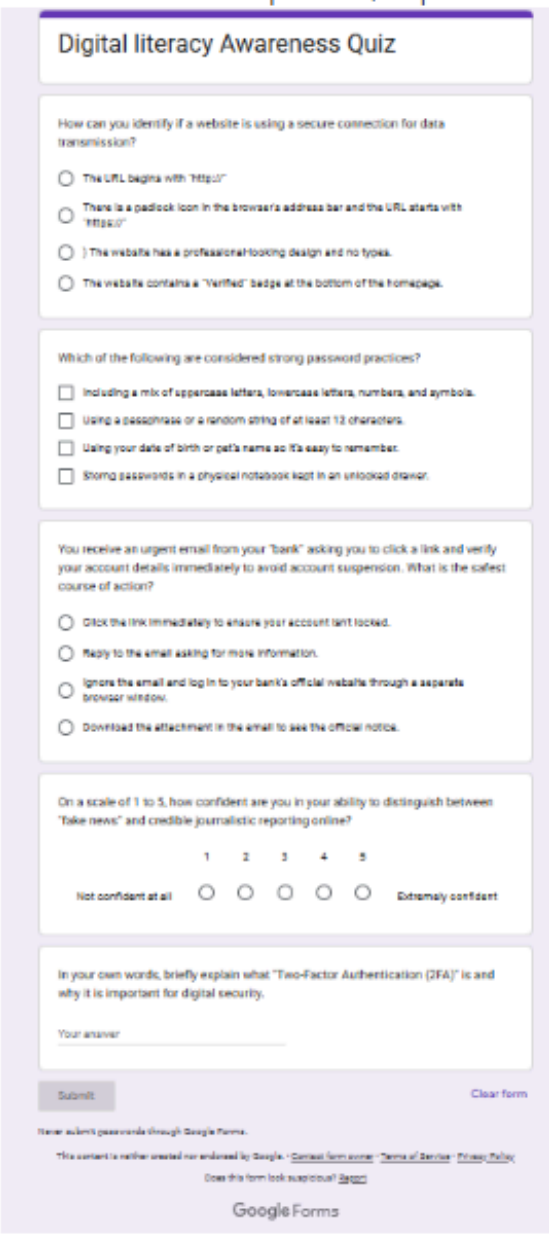




Part B: Google Workspace Collaboration

To promote digital literacy within my batch, I developed a collaborative feedback and assessment system using Google Workspace.

Digital Literacy Awareness QuizA 5-question assessment designed to evaluate and improve the digital safety and efficiency of peers.Form Link: [https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSd2uWi2xM6sC11FIqmGhx-DVbQntHu45ZwwtjLUsihTrsf-MQ/viewform?usp=publish-editor]
Evidence:Form Preview: Screenshot located in task-3-platforms/Response Sheet: Screenshot of the linked Google Sheet (Response View)



Digital literacy Awareness Quiz

How can you identify if a website is using a secure connection for data transmission?

- The URL begins with "http://"
- There is a padlock icon in the browser's address bar and the URL starts with "https://"
-) The website has a professional-looking design and no typos.
- The website contains a "Verified" badge at the bottom of the homepage.

Which of the following are considered strong password practices?

- [ ] Including a mix of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and symbols.
- [ ] Using a passphrase or a random string of at least 12 characters.
- [ ] Using your date of birth or pet's name so it's easy to remember.
- [ ] Storing passwords in a physical notebook kept in an unlocked drawer.

You receive an urgent email from your "bank" asking you to click a link and verify your account details immediately to avoid account suspension. What is the safest course of action?

- Click the link immediately to ensure your account isn't locked.
- Reply to the email asking for more information.
- Ignore the email and log in to your bank's official website through a separate browser window.
- Download the attachment in the email to see the official notice.

On a scale of 1 to 5, how confident are you in your ability to distinguish between "fake news" and credible journalistic reporting online?

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not confident at all	○	○	○	○	○	Extremely confident

In your own words, briefly explain what "Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)" is and why it is important for digital security.

Your answer

Submit

Clear form

Never submit passwords through Google Forms.

This content is neither created nor endorsed by Google. · Contact form owner · Terms of Service · Privacy Policy

Does this form look suspicious? Report

Google Forms

located in task-3-platforms/

CodeChef to enhance my technical proficiency. I successfully completed the 'Solve Me First' challenge under the Python Introduction category, cementing foundational syntax and logic. On the collaboration front, I leveraged Google Workspace to promote digital literacy within my batch. I developed a 5-question 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' using Google Forms to evaluate and improve the digital safety of my peers, integrating it with Google Sheets for real-time response tracking. This experience highlighted the seamless nature of cloud tools in managing data and facilitating instant feedback. Building this automated assessment system not only improved my organizational skills but also demonstrated how effectively technology can be harnessed for peer education and collaborative learning.

Part A: Coding Practice (CodeChef)

Part B: Google Workspace Collaboration

Task 4: Communication & Professional Correspondence

Clear and professional communication is the cornerstone of effective leadership and collaboration. This task demonstrated the ability to navigate formal academic correspondence and establish responsible social media practices. The primary scenario involved writing an Academic Extension Request to a professor. Key features of this communication included clear identification of the course, a valid, respectful reason for the delay, and a proposed new deadline. This exercise underscored the importance of etiquette rules regarding subject lines, greetings, and sign-offs. Alongside professional email etiquette, I compiled a 'Social Media Do’s and Don’ts' checklist tailored for college students. Key learnings from this task emphasize that our digital communications—whether private emails or public posts—leave a lasting imprint. Maintaining a positive, respectful tone and strictly separating personal grievances from professional channels are essential habits for protecting one's emerging professional brand.

Social Media Do's and Don'ts Checklist

Email 1
Write an email from a student to their professor requesting an extension on an
assignment submission deadline. The email must follow all professional email rules.

Subject: Extension Request: Request for Extend Submission Deadline

Dear Professor ,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am writing to respectfully request an extension on the upcoming assignment, **1/5/26**, which is currently due on **[1/4/26]**.

Due to unforeseen circumstances, I have been
unable to complete the assignment to the standard I strive to maintain, I am finding it difficult to complete the assignment to the best of my ability by the original deadline. I take my studies seriously and want to ensure that the work I submit reflects a thorough understanding of the course material.

If possible, I would like to request an extension . I am confident that this additional time will allow me to finish the project at the professional standard required for this course.

Thank you for your time and for considering my request. I look forward to hearing from you.

Best regards,

SAMRIDH MISHRA
25BCE10848

EMAIL 2
Write an email from a student to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity.

Subject: Summer Internship Inquiry – Samridh Mishra (25BCE10848)– VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

Dear Coordinator,

I hope you are having a productive week.

I am writing to formally express my interest in a summer internship opportunity with the Department Btech Engineering or Marketing team at TCS. As a student at VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY pursuing a degree in Computer Science,

My academic background has provided me with a solid foundation in python , java . Additionally, I have gained practical experience through **specific project,** where I successfully. I am eager to apply this skillset to contribute to the impactful work being done at your organization.

I have attached my resume for your review. I would welcome the chance to discuss how my background aligns with the goals of your internship program.

Thank you for your time and for considering my application. I look forward to hearing from you.

Best regards,

Samridh Mishra (25BCE10848)
Phone No.- 7007XXXXX
VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

Do's	Don'ts
• **Think before you post:** Consider long-term impact.	• **Don't share sensitive info:** Avoid posting address or private data.
• **Protect your privacy:** Use strong passwords and settings.	• **Don't engage in harmful behavior:** Refrain from cyberbullying.
• **Verify information:** Check facts before sharing.	• **Don't post inappropriate content:** Avoid offensive material.
• **Be respectful:** Maintain positive interactions.	• **Don't believe everything you see:** Be critical of information.
• **Manage your time:** Set limits to ensure balance.	• **Don't overshare:** Avoid broadcasting real-time locations.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

Understanding the mechanics of modern cybercrime is critical for digital safety. This task delved into a case study on Unified Payments Interface (UPI) Fraud, a prevalent financial cybercrime in India. What surprised me most was that attackers rarely rely on highly sophisticated technical hacking; instead, they exploit Social Engineering. By manipulating trust and creating a false sense of urgency (e.g., claiming a user must enter a PIN to receive a refund), scammers easily trick victims. The biggest revelation was the simplicity of the 'Request Money' trick combined with optional screen-sharing apps. The prevention checklist outlined actionable steps to secure one's digital life. The most crucial habit I am changing immediately is auditing my reliance on passwords; I am transitioning to robust Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) for all essential accounts and strictly adhering to the rule that a UPI PIN is never required to receive money.

Prevention Checklist Highlights

• **Financial & UPI Safety:** Never Enter PIN to Receive Money. Verify UPI IDs Before Paying.

• **Account & Password Security:** Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) and use Unique Passwords.

Case Study: UPI and Online Payment Fraud

Overview of the Crime

Unified Payments Interface (UPI) and online payment fraud encompass deceptive schemes where malicious actors manipulate individuals into transferring funds or divulging sensitive authorization credentials. As digital payment adoption accelerates globally, these platforms have become lucrative hunting grounds for cybercriminals.

Step-by-Step Execution

1. Initial Contact: Fraudsters target victims via SMS, phone calls, or social media. They frequently masquerade as legitimate bank representatives, telecom customer support, or eager buyers on peer-to-peer marketplace platforms.

2. The Hook: The attacker fabricates a compelling scenario—such as a blocked account, an urgent KYC verification, or an immediate advance payment for a listed product.

3. The Deception: The fraudster sends a malicious link or a QR code. They falsely instruct the victim that entering their UPI PIN or scanning the code is required to *receive* money or verify their account.

4. The Transaction: Crucially, a UPI PIN is only needed to *deduct* money. Once the unwary victim inputs their PIN, funds are instantly transferred from their bank account to the attacker's wallet.

Typical Targets

While any digital user is at risk, cybercriminals disproportionately target elderly individuals, recent adopters of online banking, and users actively engaging in rapid transactions on online resale platforms who may overlook security warnings in the rush of a sale.

Consequences

The primary consequence is irreversible financial loss, as instant peer-to-peer transfers are exceedingly difficult for banks to trace and reverse. Furthermore, victims suffer profound psychological distress, a loss of trust in digital financial systems, and potential long-term vulnerability if banking credentials remain compromised.

• **Browsing & Connectivity:** Avoid Public Wi-Fi for Sensitive Tasks and always check the URL for HTTPS.

• **Social & Device Safety:** Audit Your Privacy Settings and Update Software Promptly.

Conclusion

The Digital Literacy Essentials project highlights that navigating the digital world effectively requires a blend of technical capability, professional etiquette, and unwavering vigilance. By systematically building a structured digital portfolio, practicing competitive coding, mastering formal communication, and analyzing real-world cybercrime scenarios, I have equipped myself with a holistic toolkit. The most profound learning is that a digital footprint is permanent and powerful; it can either expose us to severe vulnerabilities or serve as a foundational asset for our careers. Embracing continuous learning and maintaining a security-first mindset are non-negotiable in an era defined by rapid technological evolution.

References

• GitHub: The standard platform for version control and code portfolio hosting.
• LinkedIn: Professional networking and personal branding platform.
• CodeChef: Competitive programming platform utilized for Python practice.
• Google Workspace (Forms & Sheets): Employed for creating and analyzing the Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz.
• National Cyber Crime Portal (India): Reference for UPI fraud prevention and official reporting channels.